Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **Zambia Reappoints Felix Mutati as Minister of Technology and Science** — Tech Africa News, 29 October 2026 ZAMBIA

  Felix Mutati has been reappointed as Zambia's Minister of Technology and Science, the ministry announced on its Facebook page. The appointment was reported on 29 October 2026.

- **Put the Woan's spectrum in orbit, says Vodacom** — TechCentral, 29 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Vodacom asked ICASA to assign the spectrum once reserved for the defunct wholesale open-access network (Woan) to mobile operators for satellite-to-phone coverage. It asked for a price below the spectrum's terrestrial value, its group CTO Dejan Kastelic told TechCentral. ICASA has committed to a high-demand spectrum auction in 2026/27 but has set no date. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **POTRAZ says it is now a gateway for investors, not a gatekeeper** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 29 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's regulator POTRAZ now licenses services, not technologies, and uses its Universal Service Fund to fund early-stage ventures, director-general Gift Machengete said in Harare on 29 October 2026. He said the fund's Innovation Drive Programme has backed more than 100 innovations. Its AI for Impact programme drew over 700 applications in 2026 and advanced 16. *Also under Innovation ecosystem and AI*.

- **Opening Remarks by H.E. Lerato D. Mataboge, AUC Commissioner for Infrastructure and Energy at the 6th AU STC on Communication and ICT (STC-CICT)** — African Union Commission, 29 October 2026 GABON AFRICA

  AU Commissioner Lerato Mataboge opened the ministerial session of the AU's 6th technical committee on communication and ICT in Libreville on 29 October 2026. She asked for a common African voice at the ITU's PP-26 conference in Doha. She also presented the Algiers Declaration on digital platforms in Africa. *Also under Regional collaboration*.

- **Mali : L'intelligence artificielle, nouveau rempart contre les cybermenaces.** — NafoloNews, 29 October 2026 MALI

  Mali's telecoms regulator AMRTP opened the 4th national cybersecurity days in Bamako on 27 October 2026, on AI and cybersecurity. Mali approved its 2026-2030 cybersecurity strategy by decree on 25 February 2026, and a security agency's founding texts on 10 June. APA reports 1,338 cybercrime cases recorded in 2025. *Also under Cybersecurity and AI*.

- **Ghana's Communications Minister confirmed as Chair of AU Committee on Communication and ICT** — Tech Review Africa, 29 October 2026 GHANA AFRICA

Ghana's communications minister, Samuel Nartey George, was confirmed as chair of the AU Specialised Technical Committee on Communication and ICT at its session in Libreville (reported 29 October 2026). George named connectivity, data governance, cybersecurity and AI as priorities for his two-year term. He called on member states to implement the continental frameworks already adopted. *Also under Regional collaboration.*

- **CBN, NITDA allay banks' fears over January 2027 data localisation deadline** — The Sun, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  The Central Bank of Nigeria and NITDA met the financial industry in Lagos on 28 October 2026 about the 1 January 2027 payment-data localisation deadline. They said sanctions would not be the first response to a missed deadline, only to deliberate breaches. A NITDA survey found 59% of 44 financial institutions expected to finish migrating on time. *Also under Data Storage and Digital Payments and Fintech.*

- **Cabinet Business - Wednesday 28 October, 2026** — State House Seychelles, Office of the President, 29 October 2026 SEYCHELLES

  Seychelles' Cabinet approved the Seychelles Digital & AI Strategy 2026–2031 on 28 October 2026. It also approved a Government Cloud and Datacenter Project on two in-country datacentres, to reduce reliance on overseas infrastructure. The ICT minister will chair a new inter-ministerial digital and AI committee. *Also under AI, Data Storage, Digital sovereignty and Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **BoT instructs institutions to embrace AI and data analytics for operational efficiency - Daily News** — Daily News (Tanzania), 29 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Bank of Tanzania Governor Emmanuel Tutuba said the bank has set up an AI and Data Innovation Hub (reported 29 October 2026). The bank has approved policies on AI adoption with safeguards for privacy and human oversight. It has signed cooperation agreements with five Tanzanian higher-learning and research institutions. *Also under AI.*

- **BoG to introduce AI directive for financial sector** — Citi Newsroom, 29 October 2026 GHANA

  The Bank of Ghana is setting up a Data Analytics and AI Department, Governor Johnson Asiama said on 29 October 2026. It is also drafting an AI directive for the financial sector. Speaking in Accra at the launch of the Ghana Statistical Service's Ghana in Numbers 2025, he asked for its data in machine-readable formats. *Also under AI and National statistics.*

- **326 MDAs spend N3.8trn on technology as Nigeria moves to localise government data** — BusinessDay, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  NITDA's director-general, Kashifu Inuwa Abdullahi, spoke at the Lagos data localisation dialogue on 28 October 2026. He said 326 government bodies spent more than N3.8 trillion on technology between June 2023 and October 2026. NITDA will set a localisation deadline for them after the financial sector's of 1 January 2027. *Also under Data Storage and Digital sovereignty.*

- **30-day ultimatum to tackle cyber fraud** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 29 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Zimbabwe's ICT minister gave POTRAZ, operators, police and platforms 30 days to agree a protocol on WhatsApp account takeovers and digital fraud. She set the deadline in Harare on 28 October 2026. She also said the National Cyber Security Strategy is before a Cabinet committee. *Also under Cybersecurity.*

Legislation and regulation

- **NatCA Unveils State-of-the-Art Telecommunications Regulatory Equipments | Sierra Leone Monitor** — Sierra Leone Monitor, 29 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Sierra Leone's National Communications Authority unveiled new systems on 28 October 2026 for spectrum monitoring, quality of service, spectrum management and broadcast monitoring. The World Bank funded them under the Sierra Leone Digital Transformation Project. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **ICASA Publishes Draft Numbering Plan Fifth Amendment Regulations, 2026** — ICASA, 29 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  ICASA published draft Numbering Plan Fifth Amendment Regulations for 30 days' public comment on 29 October 2026. They would require biometric verification of new and existing mobile subscribers when numbers are activated or reactivated and at every SIM swap. They would also cap numbers per subscriber and limit how long visitors' numbers stay active. *Also under Digital Identity and CRVS and Data protection*.

- **Conseil des ministres : Fonction publique, justice et transports au menu** — Les Dépêches du Tchad, 29 October 2026 CHAD

  Chad's Council of Ministers examined a draft decree on electronic court procedures on 29 October 2026. It covers electronic communication and the digitisation of civil, commercial, social and administrative cases. The Ministry of Justice and Human Rights submitted it. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

Data protection

- **Qu'est-ce que la Journée Nationale de la Protection des Données Personnelles (JNPDP) ? - IPDCP** — IPDCP, 29 October 2026 TOGO

  Togo's data-protection authority IPDCP set its national data-protection day on 29 October, the date of Law 2019-014 on personal data protection. The first edition, in 2026, took data governance and digital sovereignty as its theme. The day itself is summarised under the Le Visionnaire report of the same date.

- **Kenya's Data Protection Commissioner engages EU call centre operators on BPO Investment** — Tech Review Africa, 29 October 2026 KENYA

  Kenya's Office of the Data Protection Commissioner hosted a delegation from an EU call-centre operators' association, with GIZ's support, to discuss outsourcing investment. The talks covered cross-border data transfers under the Data Protection Act. The office described adequacy discussions between Kenya and the EU as ongoing. *Also under ICT Industry*.

- **Journée Nationale de la Protection des données personnelles : le Togo mise sur la souveraineté numérique | Levisionnaire** — Le Visionnaire, 29 October 2026 TOGO

  Togo's data-protection authority IPDCP held the country's first national data-protection day in Lomé on 29 October 2026. Its peers from Benin, Mali, Burkina Faso and Senegal attended. IPDCP named three priorities: enforcing the rules, including on biometrics and data transfers abroad; national and regional hosting, including sovereign cloud; and training data-protection correspondents. *Also under Digital sovereignty*.

- **Gabon Connect : le ministère de l'Economie sollicite l'expertise de l'APDPVP** — GabonMediaTime, 29 October 2026 GABON

Gabon's economy ministry asked the data protection authority, APDPVP, for technical support on the Gabon Connect e-services platform (reported 29 October 2026). The aim is to bring the platform into line with data protection law. Its next modules, the single payroll declaration (DUS) and TrésorPay, have yet to go live. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Cameroon's AI Data Centre: Five Legal Questions Before the First Server Is Installed - CLG Global** — CLG Global, 29 October 2026 CAMEROON

  A CLG Global analysis sets out five legal questions for Cybastion's planned US$75 million AI data centre in Douala. Cybastion announced the project in August 2026. The analysis notes that the data protection authority, which must authorise transfers abroad, awaits a presidential decree and is not yet operational. *Also under Data Storage and Public debate and participation in policymaking*.

- **ICASA Publishes Draft Numbering Plan Fifth Amendment Regulations, 2026** — ICASA, 29 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Regional collaboration

- **Kagame pledges to champion Digital Public Infrastructure at African Union Level** — Tech Review Africa, 29 October 2026 RWANDA

  President Kagame pledged to champion digital public infrastructure at African Union level when he received the new Private Sector CEOs DPI Coalition in Kigali, reported on 29 October 2026. AfricaNenda and Equity Group co-lead the coalition. The talks covered interoperable continental payments, financial inclusion and AfCFTA integration. *Also under Digital Payments and Fintech*.

- **FRATEL 2026 à Conakry : la Guinée au cœur du défi de la connectivité numérique pour tous** — Guinéenews, 29 October 2026 GUINEA

  Guinea hosted the 24th annual meeting of FRATEL, the network of French-speaking telecoms regulators, in Conakry on 29–30 October 2026. Mamady Doumbouya, head of the regulator ARPT, said Guinea has 13 million mobile subscribers and about 12,000 km of fibre. More than 600 localities still lack coverage. *Also under Connectivity and Digital divides*.

- **Egypt, Uganda discuss cooperation in digital transformation, AI** — State Information Service (Egypt), 29 October 2026 UGANDA EGYPT

  Uganda's State Minister for ICT, Joyce Ssebugwawo, held talks in Cairo with Egypt's ICT minister, Raafat Hindi (reported 29 October 2026). They discussed digital transformation, training and Egyptian support for Uganda's national AI strategy. The two sides agreed to sign a memorandum of understanding later. *Also under AI and Training and skills*.

- **COMESA Workshop Seeks Financing for Affordable Regional Digital Infrastructure** — COMESA, 29 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  COMESA held a workshop in Addis Ababa on 27–30 October 2026 on financing affordable digital infrastructure. Salience Consulting leads the related regional work on least-cost planning and financing models. Citing ITU figures, an Ethiopian official said 36% of Africans use the internet: 21% in rural areas and 55% in towns. *Also under Connectivity and Digital divides*.

- **AU Media and Information Literacy Framework to harmonize fragmented standards** — Connecting Africa, 29 October 2026 AFRICA

  The African Union Commission's Media and Information Literacy Framework was reported at validation stage on 29 October 2026. Begun in 2025 with UNESCO support, it would set a continental standard for teaching media, information and AI literacy. A Zimbabwean official said about nine of 54 African states include such literacy in national curricula. *Also under Literacy*.

- **Africa's data must benefit its people, not foreign tech firms – Sam George** — Citi Newsroom, 29 October 2026 GHANA AFRICA

  Ghana's communications minister, Samuel Nartey George, spoke in Libreville on taking the chair of the AU's ICT committee (reported 29 October 2026). He said African data should serve Africans and not be extracted and sold back to them. He said 55 countries negotiating as one market would have more bargaining power on AI and digital trade. *Also under Digital sovereignty*.

- **Opening Remarks by H.E. Lerato D. Mataboge, AUC Commissioner for Infrastructure and Energy at the 6th AU STC on Communication and ICT (STC-CICT)** — African Union Commission, 29 October 2026 GABON AFRICA

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- **Ghana's Communications Minister confirmed as Chair of AU Committee on Communication and ICT** — Tech Review Africa, 29 October 2026 GHANA AFRICA

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Standards

- **Thomas Denfer : « Un registre fiable permet de renforcer l'entrepreneuriat »** — L'Économiste Maghrébin, 29 October 2026 TUNISIA

  At the colloquium for the centenary of Tunisia's national business register (RNE), Thomas Denfer spoke for the Alliance francophone des registres du commerce. He said its review of about fifteen registers found a common model built on legibility, interoperability and digitised data. The alliance was founded four years ago and has about 20 member countries. *Also under Registries*.

- **Supporting responsible AI investment in emerging markets** — British International Investment, 29 October 2026 GLOBAL

  British International Investment published a Responsible AI Due Diligence Toolkit for investors in emerging markets, developed with Reframe Venture. It sets due-diligence questions on discrimination, privacy, security and accountability risks in companies that build or use AI. *Also under AI*.

- **Device Checker: Nigeria introduces app to simplify phone verification** — TechCabal, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria's communications regulator, the NCC, announced a Device Checker app on 29 October 2026. Authorised manufacturers, importers, distributors and dealers use it to scan handset IMEIs and upload device data. The NCC is also licensing phone dealers in Kano State. *Also under Access to services*.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Sociedade civil sai a rua esta sexta-feira em protesto contra os serviços prestados pela CST** — Téla Nón, 29 October 2026 SÃO TOMÉ

A civil-society movement in São Tomé and Príncipe called a street protest for 30 October 2026 over the prices and service quality of CST, the telecoms operator that is 49% state-owned. CST replied that tariff changes need approval from the regulator AGER. It said it had waited 22 months for approval of proposed improvements. *Also under Connectivity*.

- **Parlamento: Governo aponta aceleração da transição digital dos processos e reforço da gestão e organização dos tribunais como prioridades** — Inforpress, 29 October 2026 CAPE VERDE

  Cabo Verde's Justice Minister Clóvis Silva opened the parliamentary State of Justice debate on 29 October 2026. He named faster digital handling of court processes, and modernised registry and identification services, among the government's justice priorities. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **Cameroon's AI Data Centre: Five Legal Questions Before the First Server Is Installed - CLG Global** — CLG Global, 29 October 2026 CAMEROON

  Summarised under Data protection.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Paratus Namibia continues to reshape the connectivity landscape** — Paratus Namibia, 29 October 2026 NAMIBIA

  Paratus Namibia says its fibre network now exceeds 5,000 km after about 600 km was added in the past year. It reports investing N$600m in its mobile network over 24 months, and it is the Namibian landing partner for the Equiano submarine cable. Its next phase includes more mobile and fibre coverage and a second data hall. *Also under Data Storage*.

- **Numérisation du secteur de la santé : Plus de 2.355 structures raccordées à la fibre optique (ministre)** — La voix de l'Algérie, 29 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Algeria's health ministry said on 28 October 2026 that more than 2,355 health facilities had been connected to fibre, working with Algérie Télécom. It said all university hospital centres are due to be digitised by 15 November 2026. A national telemedicine system and teleradiology are being rolled out with the electronic medical record. *Also under Sectoral management information systems*.

- **MTN plans large data centre in Nigeria** — ThisDay, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  MTN Group chief executive Ralph Mupita told journalists in Lagos on 28 October 2026 that MTN aspires to build a large data centre in Nigeria for sovereign data needs. He gave no site, capacity, cost or date. He also named fibre to homes and businesses as MTN's main Nigerian priority for the next five to ten years. *Also under Data Storage and Digital sovereignty*.

- **Msaka discloses plans to connect 2, 000 primary and secondary schools across Malawi** — Malawi Voice, 29 October 2026 MALAWI

  Malawi's Education Minister Bright Msaka said on 29 October 2026 that 2,000 primary and secondary schools will be connected to the internet. The work falls under the World Bank-supported Digital Malawi Acceleration Project, with the Malawi Research and Education Network central to delivery. He gave no timeline or cost. *Also under Access to services*.

- **GSMA Calls for More Affordable Smartphones as Over Half of Gabon's Population Remains Off Mobile Internet Despite Network Coverage** — GSMA, 29 October 2026 GABON

  A GSMA report on Gabon, reported on 28 October 2026, finds four in ten Gabonese use mobile internet, though 4G reaches 95%. The report proposes removing the 18% VAT on entry-level smartphones and cutting operator charges from 11% to 3% of gross revenue. It estimates these steps could bring about 190,000 more people online by 2031. *Also under Access to services and Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Sociedade civil sai a rua esta sexta-feira em protesto contra os serviços prestados pela CST** — Téla Nón, 29 October 2026 SÃO TOMÉ

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

- **Put the Woan's spectrum in orbit, says Vodacom** — TechCentral, 29 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **NatCA Unveils State-of-the-Art Telecommunications Regulatory Equipments | Sierra Leone Monitor** — Sierra Leone Monitor, 29 October 2026 SIERRA LEONE

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

- **FRATEL 2026 à Conakry : la Guinée au cœur du défi de la connectivité numérique pour tous** — Guinéenews, 29 October 2026 GUINEA

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Data Storage

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- **326 MDAs spend N3.8trn on technology as Nigeria moves to localise government data** — BusinessDay, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Cybersecurity

- **En Côte d'Ivoire, une simulation nationale pour «apprendre à réagir» aux cyberattaques majeures** — RFI, 29 October 2026 CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Côte d'Ivoire's information-systems security agency, ANSSI, ran a national cyberattack simulation, Cyber.Ex, in Abidjan on 28–29 October 2026. ANSSI names energy, finance and telecommunications as the most targeted sectors. It says it has recorded 147 major vulnerabilities since January 2026, leading to data leaks, outages and ransom demands.

- **Elections national results hub opens** — ITWeb South Africa, 29 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  South Africa's Electoral Commission opened its National Results Operations Centre at Gallagher Convention Centre on 28 October 2026. It declared its results system ready after an independent audit. Five political parties audited it on 8–12 October 2026, and 29.2 million voters are registered for the local government elections. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Mali : L'intelligence artificielle, nouveau rempart contre les cybermenaces.** — NafoloNews, 29 October 2026 MALI

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **30-day ultimatum to tackle cyber fraud** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 29 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

DPI

Data Exchange

- **État civil : le Cameroun s'inspire de la Côte d'Ivoire pour interconnecter ses données** — We Are Tech Africa, 29 October 2026 CAMEROON CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Cameroon's civil registration bureau BUNEC visited Côte d'Ivoire's ONECI in Abidjan from 26 to 30 October 2026. Cameroon plans to computerise and interconnect 432 main registry centres by 2029. ONECI reported its CityWeb software in every centre, online e-certified birth extracts, and weak connectivity in some centres. *Also under Registries.*

- **Zanzibar to link identity card with land ownership records to curb disputes** — The Citizen (Tanzania), 29 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Zanzibar plans to link Zan ID card details to land ownership records through LARIS, a land registration system being built by the French firm IGN FI. The project coordinator said on 29 October 2026 that the project runs from June 2026 to May 2028. Its nine components include digitising land documents. *Also under Registries and Digital Identity and CRVS.*

- **Ensino: estudantes passam a comprovar diplomas por código QR sem deslocar-se ao INAAREES** — Portal de T.I, 29 October 2026 ANGOLA

Angola's Council of Ministers assessed a presidential decree on recognising higher-education studies on 27 October 2026. Institutions would send records directly to the accreditation institute INAAREES, and diplomas would carry a verification QR code. Earlier graduates keep the current procedure through the SEPE portal for a three-year transition. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov.*

- **Cameroon looks to Côte d'Ivoire to advance digital civil registration | Biometric Update** — Biometric Update, 29 October 2026 CAMEROON CÔTE D'IVOIRE

  Cameroon's civil-registration office, BUNEC, sent a study mission to Côte d'Ivoire's ONECI on 26–30 October 2026 on digitisation and interoperability. Cameroon has computerised 60 of its 432 principal civil-registration centres. It aims to computerise all of them by 2029. *Also under Registries.*

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **Digital driver identification in Tanzania** — Stronghold, 29 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Officials and motorcycle-taxi associations met in Dodoma to discuss Jamii Wezeshi, a government platform registering drivers for health insurance, social security and loans (reported 29 October 2026). Permanent Secretary Eliakim Chacha Maswi said the data should guide support for drivers. The association CHAMWAPITA proposed a unified database of drivers and loan recipients. *Also under Registries.*

- **Zanzibar to link identity card with land ownership records to curb disputes** — The Citizen (Tanzania), 29 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Summarised under Data Exchange.

- **ICASA Publishes Draft Numbering Plan Fifth Amendment Regulations, 2026** — ICASA, 29 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  Summarised under Legislation and regulation.

Digital Payments and Fintech

- **Stablecoins drive Africa's growing crypto economy** — ITWeb Africa, 29 October 2026 SUB-SAHARAN AFRICA

  Chainalysis's 2026 Geography of Crypto Report, as reported by ITWeb Africa, puts Sub-Saharan Africa's crypto economy at USD 101bn, up 13.4% and the fastest growth of any region. South Africa grew 52% to USD 39.3bn and Nigeria fell 3% to USD 38.1bn. Stablecoins received through peer-to-peer channels rose from USD 2.3bn in 2022 to USD 14.6bn in 2026.

- **GoTyme targets third-largest bank status by early 2027** — ITWeb South Africa, 29 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

  GoTyme Bank, the South African digital bank formerly branded TymeBank, reported more than 13 million customers on 29 October 2026. Chief executive Cheslyn Jacobs said it expects to become the country's third-largest bank in the last quarter of 2026. The bank plans a credit card and wider lending through Sanlam in 2027.

- **Kagame pledges to champion Digital Public Infrastructure at African Union Level** — Tech Review Africa, 29 October 2026 RWANDA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **CBN, NITDA allay banks' fears over January 2027 data localisation deadline** — The Sun, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Registries

- **From Informal Landmarks to Sovereign Data: The Governance Challenge Facing Digital Postcodes** — Tech Africa News, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Nigeria launched its National Digital Alphanumeric Postcode System on 1 October 2026. Each addressable building gets an 11-character code. The National Addressing Council approved links to the NIMC identity database and the CAC business registry, Tech Africa News reported on 29 October 2026. Public lookups run through Amazon Web Services. Where the database itself is held is not shown. *Also under Digital sovereignty*.

- **Adel Chouari : « D'ici 2027, fini les copies conformes dans les administrations »** — L'Économiste Maghrébin, 29 October 2026 TUNISIA

  Tunisia's business registry, the RNE, aims to end requests for certified copies in public administrations by 2027. Its director-general, Adel Chouari, said so at an RNE colloquium (reported 29 October 2026). Authenticated electronic documents would carry the same legal value as paper, so firms could complete procedures remotely. *Also under Other GovTech and e-Gov*.

- **État civil : le Cameroun s'inspire de la Côte d'Ivoire pour interconnecter ses données** — We Are Tech Africa, 29 October 2026 CAMEROON CÔTE D'IVOIRE

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Sectoral management information systems

- **Numérisation du secteur de la santé : Plus de 2.355 structures raccordées à la fibre optique (ministre)** — La voix de l'Algérie, 29 October 2026 ALGERIA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **مصلحة الجوازات تتلقى 773 طلباً للحصول على التأشيرات الإلكترونية خلال أسبوع** — Libyan News Agency (LANA), 29 October 2026 LIBYA

  Libya's Passports, Nationality and Foreigners Affairs Authority received 773 e-visa applications from 78 nationalities between 23 and 29 October 2026. It approved 610 and refused 65, and 98 were still pending.

- **Somalia Parliament Suspends Sessions for Two Weeks to Install E-Parliament System** — Dawan Africa, 29 October 2026 SOMALIA

  Somalia's House of the People will suspend sessions for two weeks from 31 October 2026 to install an E-Parliament system. The Speaker said it would take members' requests online and bring digital attendance and electronic voting.

- **Executivo anuncia concurso público internacional para modernizar o Portal SIMPLIFICA** — Portal de T.I, 29 October 2026 ANGOLA

  Angola's Institute for Administrative Modernisation (IMA) opened an international tender for a new platform for the SIMPLIFICA public-services portal. A US$300 million World Bank loan for the Angola Digital Acceleration Project pays for it. Bids close on 27 November 2026.

- **El Gobierno analiza el contrato de VFS Global para reforzar el sistema de visados en línea y potenciar la promoción turística** — Guinea Ecuatorial Press, 29 October 2026 EQ. GUINEA

  Equatorial Guinea's vice-presidency reviewed the VFS Global e-visa contract before formalising it (reported 29 October 2026). About 35,127 e-visas have been processed since launch on 1 July 2023, against an expected 200,000 a year. VFS proposed automated applicant assistance and document data-extraction tools.

- **Parlamento: Governo aponta aceleração da transição digital dos processos e reforço da gestão e organização dos tribunais como prioridades** — Inforpress, 29 October 2026 CAPE VERDE

  Summarised under Public debate and participation in policymaking.

- **GSMA Calls for More Affordable Smartphones as Over Half of Gabon's Population Remains Off Mobile Internet Despite Network Coverage** — GSMA, 29 October 2026 GABON

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- **Elections national results hub opens** — ITWeb South Africa, 29 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

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- **Conseil des ministres : Fonction publique, justice et transports au menu** — Les Dépêches du Tchad, 29 October 2026 CHAD

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Technology

AI

- **US and Mozambican governments partner with Google to prepare the public sector for the era of superintelligence** — Preto & Branco, 29 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  The US Embassy in Maputo and Mozambique's communications and digital transformation ministry held a one-day Google training course for civil servants on 29 October 2026. It covered AI, data policy and cloud computing in public administration. It was Google's second training activity in Mozambique that month, after a virtual session for 100 entrepreneurs. *Also under Training and skills and US / hyperscaler activities.*

- **Talent Nation Raises Pre-Seed Funding to Train One Million AI Engineers in Africa** — Tech Africa News, 29 October 2026 AFRICA

  Talent Nation, which trains AI engineers, announced pre-seed funding of an undisclosed amount from investors including Enza Capital, LocalGlobe and Future Africa. It aims to train one million AI engineers in Africa over ten years. The company reports about 1,400 fellows on nine campuses and more than 63,000 applicants. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Guinea launches AI Open Days to train 160 public administration officials** — Tech Review Africa, 29 October 2026 GUINEA

  Guinea's universal-service agency ANSUTEN launched AI Open Days on 28 October 2026 with training for 160 officials from four ministries on AI in public administration. The programme runs under R-CUN with Africa Digital Academy. *Also under Training and skills.*

- **Supporting responsible AI investment in emerging markets** — British International Investment, 29 October 2026 GLOBAL

  Summarised under Standards.

- **POTRAZ says it is now a gateway for investors, not a gatekeeper** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 29 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Mali : L'intelligence artificielle, nouveau rempart contre les cybermenaces.** — NafoloNews, 29 October 2026 MALI

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Egypt, Uganda discuss cooperation in digital transformation, AI** — State Information Service (Egypt), 29 October 2026 UGANDA EGYPT

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **Cabinet Business - Wednesday 28 October, 2026** — State House Seychelles, Office of the President, 29 October 2026 SEYCHELLES

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **BoT instructs institutions to embrace AI and data analytics for operational efficiency - Daily News** — Daily News (Tanzania), 29 October 2026 TANZANIA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **BoG to introduce AI directive for financial sector** — Citi Newsroom, 29 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

ICT Industry

- **Kenya's Data Protection Commissioner engages EU call centre operators on BPO Investment** — Tech Review Africa, 29 October 2026 KENYA

  Summarised under Data protection.

Innovation ecosystem

- **POTRAZ says it is now a gateway for investors, not a gatekeeper** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 29 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Capacity

Literacy

- **AU Media and Information Literacy Framework to harmonize fragmented standards** — Connecting Africa, 29 October 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Training and skills

- **US and Mozambican governments partner with Google to prepare the public sector for the era of superintelligence** — Preto & Branco, 29 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Summarised under AI.

- **Talent Nation Raises Pre-Seed Funding to Train One Million AI Engineers in Africa** — Tech Africa News, 29 October 2026 AFRICA

  Summarised under AI.

- **Guinea launches AI Open Days to train 160 public administration officials** — Tech Review Africa, 29 October 2026 GUINEA

  Summarised under AI.

- **Egypt, Uganda discuss cooperation in digital transformation, AI** — State Information Service (Egypt), 29 October 2026 UGANDA EGYPT

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Inclusion

Access to services

- **ZIMSTAT targets households, businesses in financial inclusion drive** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 29 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  ZIMSTAT is listing households and businesses across all ten provinces, from 19 October to 13 November 2026, to select samples for the FinScope Consumer and MSME surveys. The surveys will measure use of banking, savings, credit, insurance and digital payments. The agency said responses stay confidential under the Census and Statistics Act. *Also under National statistics.*

- **Msaka discloses plans to connect 2, 000 primary and secondary schools across Malawi** — Malawi Voice, 29 October 2026 MALAWI

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **GSMA Calls for More Affordable Smartphones as Over Half of Gabon's Population Remains Off Mobile Internet Despite Network Coverage** — GSMA, 29 October 2026 GABON

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Device Checker: Nigeria introduces app to simplify phone verification** — TechCabal, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Standards.

Digital divides

- **FRATEL 2026 à Conakry : la Guinée au cœur du défi de la connectivité numérique pour tous** — Guinéenews, 29 October 2026 GUINEA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **COMESA Workshop Seeks Financing for Affordable Regional Digital Infrastructure** — COMESA, 29 October 2026 ETHIOPIA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

Data

National statistics

- **ZIMSTAT targets households, businesses in financial inclusion drive** — The Herald (Zimbabwe), 29 October 2026 ZIMBABWE

  Summarised under Access to services.

- **BoG to introduce AI directive for financial sector** — Citi Newsroom, 29 October 2026 GHANA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

Geopolitics

US / hyperscaler activities

- **US and Mozambican governments partner with Google to prepare the public sector for the era of superintelligence** — Preto & Branco, 29 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

  Summarised under AI.

Digital sovereignty

- **MTN plans large data centre in Nigeria** — ThisDay, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Connectivity.

- **Journée Nationale de la Protection des données personnelles : le Togo mise sur la souveraineté numérique | Levisionnaire** — Le Visionnaire, 29 October 2026 TOGO

  Summarised under Data protection.

- **From Informal Landmarks to Sovereign Data: The Governance Challenge Facing Digital Postcodes** — Tech Africa News, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Registries.

- **Cabinet Business - Wednesday 28 October, 2026** — State House Seychelles, Office of the President, 29 October 2026 SEYCHELLES

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

- **Africa's data must benefit its people, not foreign tech firms – Sam George** — Citi Newsroom, 29 October 2026 GHANA AFRICA

  Summarised under Regional collaboration.

- **326 MDAs spend N3.8trn on technology as Nigeria moves to localise government data** — BusinessDay, 29 October 2026 NIGERIA

  Summarised under Strategies, plans and policies.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	**2026-10-30**
RETENTION	Kept until 2026-11-06. Older bulletins: the country and region news.
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Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country and region news.